league. He deplored how ‘Sethna is Pochkhanawala and Pochkhanawala is Sethna when they agree and how each affects to ignore all knowledge when it suits them to differ like Shukla Jamasp.’[13] However, Sir Dinshaw’s doubts do not appear to be borne out by the correspondence with Sir Phiroze on the subject. In a letter to Sir Dinshaw dated October 30, 1928, Sir Phiroze wrote: ‘I gave him clearly to understand that the Directors have made up their minds to bury the past if he was prepared to do likewise and work in accordance with all the rules and regulations we have laid down. He was very pliant and I have an idea that he has come to the conclusion that it will not pay him to put up a fight.’[14]

After a stormy Board meeting on November 8, 1928, Sir Phiroze wrote to Sir Dinshaw telling him that he had made matters plain to Sorabji about where he stood with the Board but missed telling him that in case the Board had to choose between the two, it would choose Masani. However, since Sorabji had decided to be amicable at the workplace there was no need to rake up old issues. Sir Phiroze also assured Sir Dinshaw that the Board would support Masani, and when Sorabji realized that it was Masani’s counsel which prevailed with the Board, then he would ‘deem it in his own interest to work harmoniously with Masani.’[15]

But Sir Phiroze’s optimism was misplaced and things only got worse. Inevitably, there came a time when both Masani and Sorabji decided that they had had enough. Sorabji was the first to resign. On December 21, 1928, seventeen years to the day that the Central Bank was registered, Sorabji put in his papers. In his letter of resignation Sorabji made it clear that he was ‘driven to it by the attitude of the Board.’ ‘I have so far exercised the greatest forbearance and put the most pleasant complexion on cases of flagrant injustice, perverse decisions and studied insults and neglect, but I feel that it is not safe for me to work any longer in such an atmosphere.’[16]

The Board asked Masani to take over but he declined, refusing ‘to accept the legacy of, and be made the scapegoat for, the Managing Director’s mismanagement.’[17] He suggested that if the Board did not want Sorabji, they could entrust the management to two officers named by Masani and whose working he would supervise as an ordinary Director. Since this was not a practical arrangement, the Board could hardly have allowed Sorabji to leave under the circumstances. The Chairman suggested to Sir Dinshaw that